

Subject: Immediate Action Required: Addressing the Challenges of SRM E-Pads for Exams

Respected Sir (Dr. K. Gunasekaran),

I hope this message finds you well. I'm writing to bring attention to some critical issues regarding the SRM E-Pads currently being used for high-stakes exams. While the technology offers potential, the current setup is proving to be physically and mentally taxing for students, and I believe we need to explore changes to enhance both user experience and overall exam performance.

Key Challenges:

1. Screen Size Limitation:

The 11-inch screen on the E-Pads is far too small for extended exam use. Students are constantly zooming and scrolling, which disrupts focus, breaks their flow, and undermines overall productivity. A larger screen would significantly improve efficiency and minimize distractions.

2. Physical Discomfort:

Writing on a smooth glass surface for extended periods leads to hand cramps, wrist fatigue, and general discomfort. The lack of friction compared to traditional pen-and-paper writing is a substantial issue, particularly for exams lasting over three hours. This physical strain detracts from cognitive performance, and many students have reported the need for workarounds, such as artist gloves or additional practice, which further complicates the adoption of this technology.

3. Mental Distractions from Device Management:

The need to manage basic features—such as erasing, navigating menus, or dealing with stylus lag—interrupts the students' concentration. The focus should be on the exam content, not the technology itself. These frequent disruptions create cognitive overload, resulting in diminished performance.

4. Handwriting Concerns:

Many students experience significant anxiety over the appearance of their handwriting on the E-Pads. The difference in writing on glass compared to paper creates uncertainty, as students worry that their handwriting will be judged, regardless of the quality of their answers. This adds an unnecessary layer of stress during exams.

5. Inefficient Review Process:

Reviewing exam answers becomes an arduous task with the current system. The inability to easily flip between pages or quickly skim the document forces students to navigate multiple screens and papers in a cumbersome way, significantly impacting their ability to manage time and ensure the accuracy of their responses.

Conclusion & Suggested Action:

In its current state, the SRM E-Pad is proving to be impractical for long-term use in high-pressure exam environments. While there is no doubt that digital tools can enhance the academic experience, the technology must be adapted to meet the specific needs of students and the demands of rigorous exam conditions.

I strongly recommend that we consider immediate adjustments, such as transitioning to a larger screen, improving the tactile feedback of the stylus, and optimizing the device's usability for smoother navigation and more efficient review. These changes are crucial for ensuring that students can perform at their best without being hindered by physical and technical limitations.

Thank you for your attention to this matter. I look forward to discussing potential solutions and working together to create a more effective exam experience for all students.

Best regards,

[Your Full Name]

[Your Position]

[Your Contact Information]